Memory: the context window

AI agents · Level 3 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Explain the context window: a model’s only memory.
- Predict what an agent forgets when the window fills.
- Choose what to keep: short notes, fewer turns, or a new conversation.

Remember

- The model reads the whole text again every time, up to its window.
- Darsi Tiny: 384 tokens; big cloud models: about 128,000.
- What falls out is gone; short notes keep what matters, and keep pupils’ data out.

The ten-word window

1. Warm-up (5 min): What did I say at the start of the lesson?
2. Teach (8 min): The context window, and what falls out.
3. Ten-word window (15 min): A story where only ten words stay.
4. Notes (7 min): Play again, keeping short notes.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Link it to agents, then the exit ticket.

You only need the board, chalk and a duster. Choose a story starter about a place your pupils know.

Let's discuss

1. When has a long chat with an agent gone wrong for you?
2. What should never go into a conversation with an agent?
3. Why might a new conversation be the best fix?

Exit ticket

- In one sentence, explain why an agent forgot something, and one way to stop it.